



MONTHLY UPDATE

Public debate and participation in policymaking: monthly update, July 2026

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17 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

Benin

Benin is [ranked fourth in Africa on a 2026 internet-freedom assessment](#) — a reference ranking, cited here and not absorbed into the ledger as a position of the state's own.

Burkina Faso

The same organic law creating the merged communications and data-protection authority folds the broadcasting regulator into it, transferring its mandate subject to promulgation; neither text is held and no commencement, seat or leadership is stated.

Burundi

ABUCO's [same 28 July statement](#) proposed a convening — états généraux bringing public authorities, operators, regulators and consumer organisations into one forum — as its remedy, the only instrument a consumer body can reach for; no response from government or operators is on file, and no convening date is stated.

Chad

On 4 August the Haute autorité des médias et de l'audiovisuel [announced](#) that it suspends, "jusqu'à nouvel ordre", examination of applications to create online newspapers. The regulator presented the freeze as implementation of its 2026–2028 three-year strategic plan, one axis of which is to clean up the profession and better address "information disorder", and said it would study new arrangements for governing online newspapers with all stakeholders. The communiqué carried no date of its own, set no end date, no published criteria and no transitional treatment for applications already filed, so the outlets already licensed become a closed list for the duration.

Cote d'Ivoire

A consumer federation [launched a complaints platform on 30 July](#) charging FCFA 150 per report, with eight stages from filing through mediation to published reports.

DR Congo

A [standing consultation mechanism between the ministry and the sector network](#) was agreed at a working session on 6 August, after the dispute over the digital-sector tariff. No constituting text, membership or meeting schedule is stated, and the agreement is known from a communiqué carried by the state news agency.

Egypt

Two administrative reforms are stated and neither is dated. The head of the Council of State told circuit presidents the Council [continues to implement an integrated digital transformation plan](#) to speed litigation, naming no system, date or deliverable — the only first-hand record that this branch has a digitisation programme at all. A [proposed cut of the VAT credit-refund period to four months, three for smaller firms](#), still awaits its legislative steps, and will not meet its objects while the problems obstructing proof of balances remain.

Gabon

The suspension of social media has now run [about five months, the Presidency calling it temporary and conservatory](#), with no lifting date given. [Nine civil-society organisations call it unconstitutional and beyond the authority's remit and demand abrogation](#). The decision's text is not held; its February start is inferred from a five-month count and, independently, from an operator's half-year filing, so the date carries month precision only.

Guinea

Neither the regulator ARPT, the operators nor the internet service providers issued an explanation for the social-media restriction. The precedent is on the record rather than inferred: under the post-coup transition a government spokesman owned a three-month digital cut and said that in Guinea the internet is not a right.

Liberia

On 30 July the Anti-Corruption Commission [confirmed it had forwarded a complaint about the telecoms traffic-monitoring arrangement to its investigation unit](#). No evidence has been publicly produced and no findings made.

Mali

The same 3 August the cybercrime pole [sentenced Chahana Takiou to 12 months with six suspended](#) on a charge of undermining the credit of the state through the judicial institution, over remarks at a Bamako media forum in June 2026 arguing that journalists should be tried under press-offence law.

Mauritius

The month's sharpest domestic contribution was an argument about priority. A [named analyst published on 2 August](#) the case that contract enforcement rather than technology limits growth, citing the World Bank's 2025 indicators — 42.2 on ease of commercial dispute resolution against Singapore's 73.3 — and more than 70,000 cases pending at end-2025. Its digital prescription is digitalised case management alongside a small-claims process. Analysis, not evidence.

Rwanda

The internet governance forum convened in Kigali on 30 July under the domain registry; a regional body announced an internet governance blueprint for a steering committee in September 2026.

Sao Tome and Principe

AGER convened the first [Fórum de Governança da Internet \(FGI STP\)](#) on 28–30 July 2026, at Casa Cacau, opened by the Prime Minister, with tracks covering digital trust, service-delivery infrastructure, regulation, privacy and data protection, and AI, framed under the theme of connectivity as a pillar for digital inclusion. It is the regulator's own convening rather than a government ministry's, and the first time São Tomé and Príncipe has run a national forum of this kind. No outcome document or date for a second edition was published.

Senegal

A ministry legal adviser stated that the state has [worked on social-media regulation since 2024](#) with no bill or timetable named.

Uganda

The same day, revised media guidelines issued through the [electronic court case-management system](#) required prior accreditation, barred devices from a courtroom and made live broadcasting a case-by-case grant.

Reporting of 29 July recorded that no work had begun on the [revenue authority's e-Tax2 procurement](#), whose technical evaluation the Appeals Tribunal set aside in October 2025 on a power-of-attorney defect; joint-venture staff have been on the authority's premises since January and none of 26 commercial banks would issue the performance guarantee gating the advance.

Zambia

The same Postal and Courier Services Bill consultation — the only open public call for written comment on a Zambian instrument the wiki holds for the whole window — closed three days after the call for written submissions was reported, with no submission count, published response or consultation report held.

On 1 August the Human Rights Commission disclosed that its case review meeting had considered 105 alleged violations linked to the election period, of which 62 were resolved administratively.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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